ISACA Chapter Leader Guidebook

Chapter Secretary

What do I need to know as a chapter secretary?

Table of Contents

Welcome! **1**

Roles and Responsibilities of the Secretary **1**

Governance 1

Meetings 2

Succession Planning **2**

Turnover Procedures 2

Appendix **3**

Timetable for Action 3

Key Links 3

Board Meeting Minutes Guidance 3

Board Meeting Minutes Template 3

All questions, concerns, comments, reports, and notifications should be submitted to ISACA Support using the "Chapter" tab.

Welcome!

Congratulations, and welcome to your role as chapter secretary!
The chapter secretary usually is seen by the membership and the community as the local representative of ISACA. You will assist the chapter board in chapter activities and efforts to ensure professional and personal growth for the membership, as well as chapter sustainability. The chapter secretary reports to the chapter president.

Roles and Responsibilities of the Secretary

Governance

The secretary is responsible for the maintenance and retention of forms, documents, and correspondence (all chapter records), including but not limited to:

- Minutes from board meetings
- Chapter bylaws
- Chapter charter

- Incorporation records
- Insurance records
- Official chapter membership list/roster (this task can be assigned to membership director)
- Conflict of Interest Statements and Willingness to Serve Agreements

Additional Roles

- Maintain data privacy, per chapter and ISACA Global policies, as well as local regulations (e.g., GDPR).
- Ensure the Conflict of Interest Statements and Willingness to Serve Agreements are signed by each volunteer. Maintain originals of these signed records.
- Assist the chapter president with establishing a chapter calendar, including target dates for task completion.
- Compare membership records with previous periods to determine the percent increase/decrease. Provide this comparison to the membership director.
- Manage member surveys and results.
- Handle all correspondence pertaining to or on behalf of the chapter. Assist in writing and sending all correspondence on behalf of the chapter.
- Collaborate with the chapter board to manage legal affairs.
- Update chapter bylaws according to changes approved by the chapter board.
- Submit reports to ISACA for compliance and award eligibility.

Meetings

- Collaborate with the chapter president to develop an agenda for each board meeting.
- Assist with scheduling meetings, and issue meeting notices for board and chapter meetings.
- Act as parliamentarian during board and chapter meetings to ensure procedures are followed per bylaws. Additional insights and ideas can be gained from reference to *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*, *11th Edition*, a manual of parliamentary procedures developed in the United States, but generally applicable to any chapter board meeting.
- Maintain accurate attendance records of board and chapter meetings. Work with program/education chair(s) to track/monitor meeting attendance.
- Call the roll and read minutes of previous meeting, as necessary.
- Record meeting minutes during the chapter board meetings, membership meetings, and annual general meeting. Distribute these minutes to the appropriate audiences and store copies of all chapter meeting minutes in the chapter's leader library on the chapter's Engage website.

Succession Planning

Though it varies from chapter to chapter (according to the chapter bylaws), your term as a chapter officer will eventually come to an end. Just as you likely found it beneficial to "Learn from your Predecessor," it would be helpful to offer a one-on-one handover meeting to the individual coming into your role.

During this meeting, you can share your insights, experiences, tips, and updates on current initiatives. Offer support and guidance to help the incoming treasurer build on all the hard work and time you devoted to the chapter. For example, you could develop a transition procedure (e.g., checklist) to help ensure most key activities are covered, and ongoing support and attention is given to items that take longer than one term to accomplish.

Turnover Procedures

When turning over to a new chapter secretary, the following should be completed:

- Ensure all files, records, and correspondence are provided in a timely manner.

- Ensure chapter annual reporting documents have been submitted to ISACA Global.
- Assist the chapter president plan a recognition dinner, ensuring all volunteers and members who participated in chapter activities throughout the year are appropriately recognized.
- Coordinate the update of the chapter files with other officers and directors/chairs. Update procedures and forms as needed.
- Support the president in preparing a list of outstanding items, which may include:
  - Invoices with attached documentation and approval to pay
  - Facilities contracts in process for the following year's events
  - Seminar or instructor contracts in process for the following year
  - All other outstanding items not completed during the chapter year
- Arrange meetings with current and incoming officers/chairs.
- Turn over current correspondence file and be sure to include any chapter support items provided by ISACA throughout the year, as some of these items are not reproduced on an annual basis.

Appendix

Timetable for Action

- Ensure all chapter events are included on the Engage website.
- Within **30 days** of the AGM:
  - Participate in the development of chapter goals and strategies for the new year.
  - Ensure all volunteers have signed and submitted the Conflict of Interest and the Statement and the Willingness to Serve Agreement to the chapter's secretary.
- Within **60 days** of the AGM:
  - Ensure the chapter's goals and strategic plans are in progress.
- Within **210 days** of the AGM:
  - Begin recruiting volunteers for the next year/term.

Key Links

- **Chapter Leader Portal**
- **Policies**
- **Chapter Bylaws Template**
- **Membership**
- **Certification**
- **Conferences**
- **Training and Education**
- **ISACA Press Room**
- **CSX**
- **COBIT**
- **One In Tech**
- **SheLeadsTech**

Board Meeting Minutes Guidance

Board Meeting Minutes Template

Board Meeting Minutes

The chapter secretary is responsible for documenting meetings fully and accurately. This includes recording key information such as the board's actions, the rationale behind decisions, elections of new officers, and reports from committees and officers. After meetings, the secretary should proofread minutes, get them approved by the chapter president, distribute them to all invitees, and have them uploaded into the Chapter Leader Community Library.

What are Board Meeting Minutes?
Board meeting minutes record the board of directors' actions and decisions. They serve as an official and legal documentation of board meetings. Effective board meeting minutes serve as a reference point for future decision-making. The core purpose of board meeting minutes is to show that the board members followed relevant procedures, complied with local laws, and aligned decisions with ISACA Global's mission.

Once approved, board minutes serve as a legal record of the meeting's proceedings.

How to Take Minutes at a Board Meeting
1. Use your agenda as a template for taking minutes.
2. Listen carefully to the main topics and document key parts of discussions.
3. Write in an objective, factual voice.
    a. When you encounter controversial issues or contentious votes, summarize the debates and arguments without adding unnecessary comments or judgments.
    b. Stick to the facts, including votes for and against a motion, abstentions, and pertinent details about discussions.
    c. Minutes should be written in such a way that someone who was not present at the meeting can follow the decisions that were made.
4. Review and proofread minutes the next day.

While there are no legal rules for what information board meeting minutes must include, most boards base their outlines on **Robert's Rules of Order**, which states minutes should include:
- The type of meeting;
- The date, time, and location of the meeting;
- A list of attendees, including nonvoting participants' names, titles, and reasons for attending;
- the time the meeting was called to order and when it was adjourned; and
- A record of motions, seconds, and whether the motion passed.

Board meetings minutes should include:
I. CALL TO ORDER
Note the location, date, and time the meeting is called to order.
II. ROLL CALL
Name all attendees, note who is absent, note if a quorum is present.
Your quorum is noted in your chapter's bylaws.
III. ORDER OF BUSINESS
    A. Unfinished Business—Include unresolved action items from previous board meetings. Approve the previous meeting's minutes and address matters that were:
        - Pending since the last meeting
        - On the previous meetings agenda but were not addressed
        - Postponed to the current meeting
    B. New Business

- List of information from reports from officers, committees, program leads.
- Agenda items, voting results, assigned action items

IV. CLOSING

1. Note the location, date, and time of the next board meeting.
2. Note the time the meeting adjourns.
3. Signatures from the secretary and president, upon approval of minutes.

Board Meeting Minutes Template

Customize the template on the next page to create consistency, accuracy, and detailed minutes for future reference. Save as PDF.

Store Meeting Minutes in your chapter's Library in your Chapter Leader Community on Engage:

- Each chapter has a Chapter Leader Community that consists of all current chapter leaders: After logging into ***engage.isaca.org***, click Communities > My Communities > *Chapter Name* Chapter Leader. Or you can log into your chapter website and select "Your Chapter Leader Community" from the Members Only Content menu.

- The Chapter President, Webmaster and Administrator (if your chapter has this role) are the Community Administrators for your Chapter Leader Community. While any chapter leader can upload files to the Library, only these roles can create new folders and organize the Chapter Leader Community library. Note that ISACA staff will not manage the chapter leader communities.

BOARD MEETING MINUTES [TEMPLATE]

[INSERT CHAPTER LOGO]

MEETING DATE	TIME	LOCATION

NAME	INITIALS	POSITION	ATTENDANCE

QUORUM PRESENT: YES ___ NO___

UNFINISHED BUSINESS
1. Approve previous meetings minutes

[ADD ITEMS AS NEEDED]

NEW BUSINESS
AGENDA:
[ADD ITEMS AS NEEDED]

The following resolutions were thoroughly discussed, amended, and adopted:
Resolved, That:
[ENTER EACH RESOLUTION]

NEXT MEETING DATE	TIME	LOCATION

On motion of [CHAPTER PRESIDENT OR PRESIDING OFFICER], the meeting adjourned at [TIME].

_____
Chapter Secretary Signature

_____
Chapter President Signature

At a regular meeting of the [CHAPTER NAME], held [LOCATION], on [DATE], the minutes of the previous meeting were read and approved.